

Report: Onsite consultation and audit walk report**DPE:** Stuart Lee**Staff member:** Martin White (interim head) and Claire Buck**Introduction and objectives:**

A visit was arranged to complete a physical audit of the school and to offer advice and guidance around GDPR compliance. Main topics discussed and reviewed were:

1. Review of GDPR status, compliance documents; website and internal documentation
2. Information security and e-learning training
3. Data retention
4. Audit walk

1. Review of GDPR status, compliance documents, leadership and governance

CB has been the main point of contact for the day to day GDPR queries with the headteacher attending onsite consultations. CB has also continued to raise awareness in school as to best practice for data protection. The school has the GDPR policy and privacy notices displayed on the school website with consent and consent withdrawal forms. Normally you would have a governor assigned for GDPR although it is appreciated that with the current changes to structures, this would not be possible at the moment.

In addition to the documents mentioned above the school should check the following documents are in place:

- Work away from school policy
- Publication scheme
- Password policy
- BYOD policy

Note: exemplar policies are available on the DPE website best practice area.

Although not statutory, the school can also consider adding the SAR and data breach procedure to the website and the schools suppliers/third party list can be displayed as a separate document rather than an appendix in the privacy notices.

2. Information security and e-learning training

Information security will continue to be a focus and risks should be mitigated as much as possible. Although this was not an information security audit, the following was identified for follow up actions:

- Check that laptops are encrypted with your IT provider.
- Add secure access codes to mobile devices and remind staff to store away securely at the end of the school day.
- 1 x personal memory stick was observed. The school should remind staff not to use unencrypted memory sticks and ideally utilize Cloud solutions for storing, sharing and collaborating. The school can also update policy/guidance to ensure all staff are aware of best practice.
- The school server was positioned in the library with the external hard drive backup. The school should review access to the area and consider adding the server to a secure cabinet, or move to a separate area. The school will also check if the back up (sitting on top of the server) was encrypted.

- If not already, staff should complete the **Stay Safe online NCSC training**. This is not only beneficial for the organisation but also for staff when accessing personal information online i.e. personal banking: <https://dataprotection.education/courses-heading/stay-safe-online-ncsc>

In addition, you can check out the National Cyber Security Centre website: [ncsc.gov.uk](https://www.ncsc.gov.uk) which has useful resources and tips for schools regarding cyber security:

- **School resources:** <https://www.ncsc.gov.uk/section/education-skills/schools>
- **Governor Qs for schools:** <https://www.ncsc.gov.uk/information/school-governor-questions>

3. Data retention

Organisations can set deadlines, document and justify timeframes they have set for retaining data. There are **two key factors**: the **purpose** for processing the data, and any **legal or regulatory requirements** for **retaining it**. One of your purposes will need to apply for you to continue to store the data. Data should not be held for longer than is needed. You shouldn't just keep data just in case you may need it in the future. CB confirmed that there is a data retention schedule in place. **Different data systems to consider when reviewing data retention are:**

- Emails
- MIS
- Website
- Third party software
- Network/CLOUD

4. Audit walk findings and raising staff awareness

The making the rounds audit is a physical audit completed onsite. The intention is to select as many working areas and locations as possible to assess (observe) how data is processed, accessed, stored and displayed.

From this audit, discussion takes place to identify better practice and where there is good practice. This is then fed back to staff to raise awareness (including additional training) and improve practice in school.

The main outcomes from the walks are about improved data handling and information security. Details of the audit walk completed on 24 June 2022 are shown below:

Information security observations: refer to section 2 Information security above.

Reception office: the office has key code entry although lack of space and secure storage for sensitive files had previously been identified as an issue. CB has completed a reshuffle and has already added the most sensitive data to secure cabinets.

Headteacher's office: Due to the office being upstairs and the nature of data that could be being worked on, the school should consider key code entry for the office.

Classrooms: In general classrooms had minimal data on display and good practice observed. Staff spoken to had a good understanding of data that should and should not be on open display. Forename only was predominantly used for lists and displays. 1 x classroom had an intervention folder open and on display; iPads had no secure codes and some classrooms used the back of cupboard doors to display sensitive data.

Feedback and considerations: Reminder to staff to check information in folders and securely destroy outdated information and/or check with office staff for secure destruction.

Remove data from the back of cupboard doors in classrooms and develop a folder, or electronic system.

Add passcodes to iPads and store securely at the end of the school day.

Library: refer to section 2 Information security above.

Kitchen: Cover staff were unable to locate the student meal allergy list.

Feedback and considerations: School to review process for ensuring staff are able to access allergy lists and ensure there is contingency in the event of staff absence.

Corridor: Photo and full name on display.

Feedback and considerations: CB to use as an opportunity to check consent against displays in school.

Staffroom: Child allergy information placed with information facing the wall.

Feedback and considerations: School to review if this is the best way to communicate such information to staff.